

A 15-SECOND STORYBOARD

Portrait 9:16, sound-off readable, the rule understood in the first five seconds: the colour you match is the tower that fires.

0-2 S · HOOK



A crowned champion lumbers towards the gate; the camera pushes in on the gate bar.

HOLD THE GATE!

Sound: Boss roar, drums hit

2-5 S · THE RULE



A finger swipes a match. Moes stream from the board to their towers, which fire.

MATCH A COLOUR, FIRE ITS TOWER

Sound: Match chime, fire whoosh

5-8 S · THE PAYOFF



The Moon is full: one tap and moonbeams strike every enemy on the road at once.

ONE TAP. WHOLE WAVE.

Sound: Rising chimes, boom, bit-stop

8-11 S · VARIETY

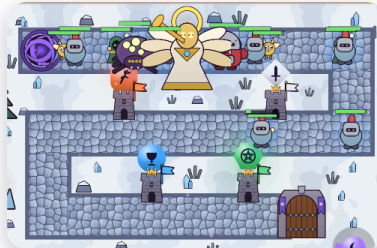


Quick cuts: shields in the desert, healers in the marsh, a Broodmother in the snow.

NEW REALM, NEW ENEMY

Sound: Music swells, one cut per beat

11-13 S · THE BOSS



Judgement descends on the Summit. The towers, crowned and flying pennants, answer.

BEAT THE ARCANA

Sound: Boss loop, steel impact

13-15 S · END CARD



ARCANA SIEGE

Match tiles to fire the towers. Hold the gate.

PLAY

Key art, the logo, a Play button that pulses. Store badges.

PLAY FREE

Sound: Victory stinger

Why this cut: the hook is a threat (a boss at the gate), the rule fits in one line of on-screen text, and the payoff is the game's most satisfying moment (a combo wiping a wave). Every frame is real gameplay captured from the build; nothing is faked, so the ad's promise matches the first minute of play.

THREE HOOKS, ONE DECISION

The prototype's first question is not "is it fun?" but "will people install it at a price we can pay back?"

CREATIVE VARIANTS

VARIANT	FIRST 2 SECONDS	WHAT IT TESTS
A · Threat (above)	A champion three steps from the gate	Tension and rescue
B · Satisfaction	A ×5 cascade clearing the board while the road empties	Pure juice, the match-3 audience
C · The choice	Two matches glow: red or grey? The Brute is armoured...	The puzzle, the TD audience

TEST DESIGN

SETTING	
Channels	Meta (Facebook/Instagram) and one ad network (AppLovin or Unity Ads), where hybrid-casual tests usually run
Geos	US for the go / kill decision; a cheaper tier-2 geo (e.g. Brazil, Turkey) to iterate creatives first
Build	The Android build behind a store page (or a soft-launch listing), analytics on
Budget	About \$150–250 per variant in the cheap geo, then the winner at about \$500 in the US
Length	3–5 days per round, a minimum of 1,000 impressions per variant before reading CTR
Rounds	Up to three creative rounds before the kill decision

GO / ITERATE / KILL (US, META)

GO

- CPI ≤ \$0.60
- CTR ≥ 3%, IPM ≥ 40 on the network
- D1 ≥ 35% from the test cohort
- Average day-0 playtime ≥ 12 minutes

Move to soft launch with the KPI plan.

ITERATE

- CPI \$0.60–1.00, or
- good CTR but a weak store conversion

Change the hook first (cheapest), then the store page (icon, first screenshot), then the first minute of play.

KILL

- CPI above \$1.00 after three creative rounds, or
- D1 below 25% even with a good CPI

The theme or the promise is not landing; pivot the fantasy (setting, hero) before spending on content.

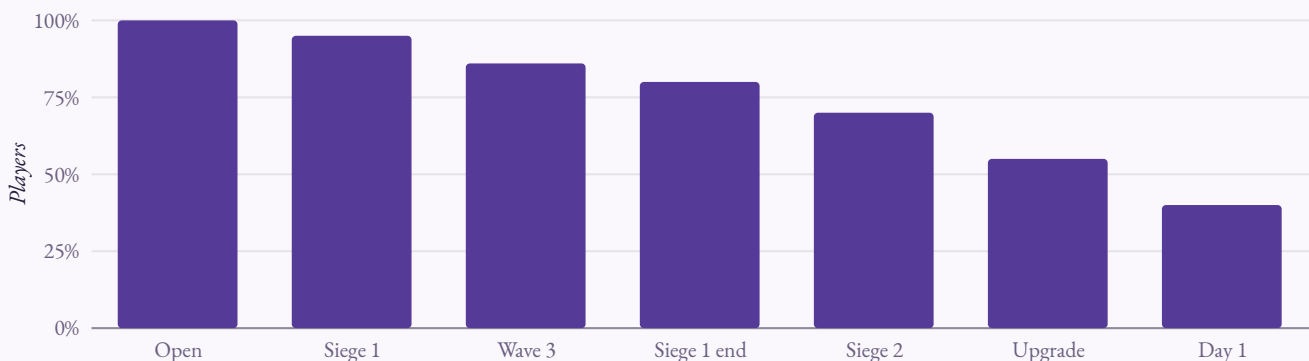
Why these numbers: hybrid-casual games earn from ads and some IAP, so a practical first target is day-30 revenue per user above the install price. With the KPI targets overleaf (D1 40%, D7 15%, ad ARPDAU ≈ \$0.08), a user earns roughly \$0.55–0.75 by day 30, which is why the go line sits at a \$0.60 CPI. These are planning assumptions to be replaced by the publisher's own benchmarks.

WHAT WE MEASURE, AND WHAT WE CHANGE

Every KPI maps to an event the game already logs through **IAalytics** (ten events; in this build they are written to a local JSON-lines file, and a real SDK drops in behind the same interface).

KPI	TARGET	MEASURED BY	IF IT MISSES
D1 retention	40%	app_open on day 1	Onboarding: first-siege win rate, wave-3 drop
D7 retention	15%	app_open on day 7	Meta: upgrade pacing, realm 2 wall, daily siege
D30 retention	5%	app_open on day 30	Content depth: realms, events
Session length	8–12 min	session timestamps	Too short: runs too hard; too long: no stopping point
Sessions per day	3+	app_open	Daily siege reminder, notifications
First siege reached wave 3	90%	wave_cleared wave 3	Waves 1–2 too slow or unclear
First siege won	60–70%	siege_end	The bot's 66%; retune if players differ
Second chance per loss	30–40%	second_chance / losses	Offer too weak, or ad fatigue
Ad ARPDAU	\$0.06–0.10	ad SDK	Placement frequency, rewarded value
Payer conversion	1–2%	store SDK	Starter pack value, remove-ads price

FIRST-SESSION FUNNEL (TARGETS)



READ DIFFICULTY IN THE WILD

siege_end by siege, result and wave is the real version of the bot's loss-by-wave table. Where players and bots disagree, the bots are wrong: retune the siege and rerun the career bot to keep the sawtooth.

READ THE ECONOMY

Gold earned per **siege_end** against **upgrade_bought**, and how long players sit on unspent gold. If upgrades lag, the Towers screen needs a nudge; if gold piles up, prices are too high.